

Analysis

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Key Takeaways

- The dataset includes **215 cargo movements** from **17 port authorities**, **69 facilities** and **180 different companies** with approximately 109 million metric tons of hazardous cargo reported in 2022. Geographic concentration is striking **İzmir (Aliağa)**, **Adana (Ceyhan)** and **Hatay (İskenderun)** dominate the volume while most other provinces handle only a sliver of the total.
- **Company-level tonnage is deeply uneven.** Just **107 of the 180 companies** clear the 20,000 ton threshold but together they move roughly **99.5% of all hazardous cargo**. Wide by headcount, narrow by liability.
- A hypothetical **50/ton levy** on those threshold crossing companies would bring in around **5.4 billion** most of it coming from the top ten handlers alone.

1. Overview of the dataset

```
overview <- hns2022 |>
  summarise(
    n_records      = n(),
    n_ports        = n_distinct(port_authority_short),
    n_facilities    = n_distinct(facility),
    n_companies     = n_distinct(company_clean),
    total_cargo_mt = sum(cargo_mt)
  )
overview
```

```
# A tibble: 1 x 5
  n_records n_ports n_facilities n_companies total_cargo_mt
  <int>    <int>    <int>      <int>      <dbl>
1      215      17         69        180    108894605.
```

215 Records

17 Port authorities

69 Facilities

180 Companies (cleaned)

108.9 M ton Total 2022 cargo

The dataset is a long table where each row pairs a **receiver company** with the **facility** that handled their cargo and the **regional port authority** that oversees that facility. The numeric column `cargo_mt` is what we'll be slicing in every direction below.

2. Where is hazardous cargo concentrated?

Each port authority is mapped to its host province, and 2022 tonnage is summed accordingly. The darker the province, the heavier the load.

```
prov_totals <- hns2022 |>
  group_by(iso2, province) |>
  summarise(total_mt = sum(cargo_mt), .groups = "drop")

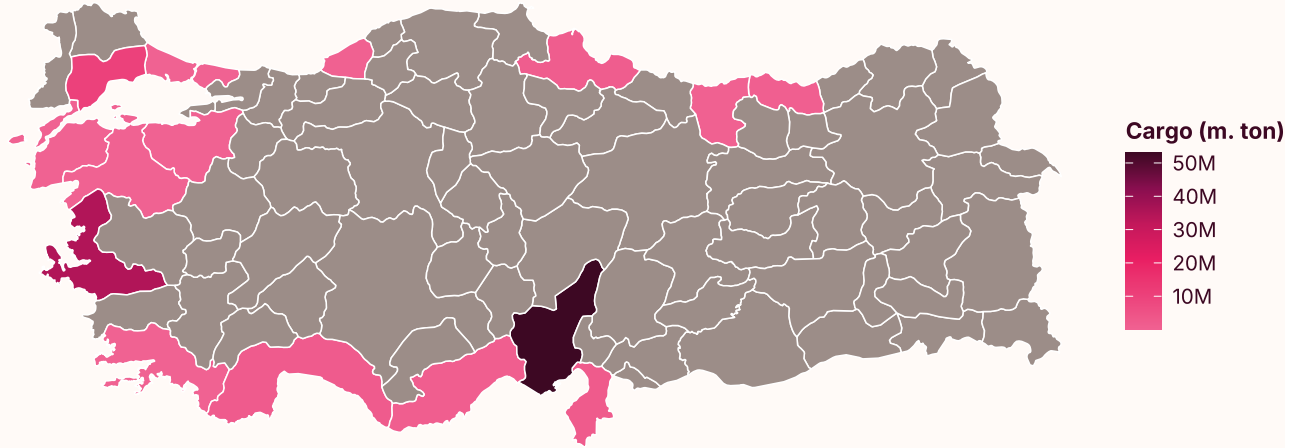
tr_states <- ne_states(country = "Turkey", returnclass = "sf")

if ("iso_3166_2" %in% names(tr_states)) {
  tr_map <- tr_states |>
  left_join(prov_totals, by = c("iso_3166_2" = "iso2"))
} else {
  norm <- function(x) tolower(stringi::stri_trans_general(x, "Any-Latin; Latin-ASCII"))
  tr_map <- tr_states |>
  mutate(name_n = norm(name)) |>
  left_join(prov_totals |> mutate(name_n = norm(province)), by = "name_n")
}

ggplot(tr_map) +
  geom_sf(aes(fill = total_mt), color = "white", linewidth = 0.35) +
  scale_fill_gradientn(
    colours = c("#F06292", "#EC407A", "#E91E63", "#C2185B", "#880E4F", "#3D0823"),
    na.value = "#9C8D88",
    labels = scales::label_number(scale_cut = scales::cut_short_scale()),
    name = "Cargo (m. ton)"
  ) +
  coord_sf(crs = 4326) +
  labs(
    title = "Türkiye's hazardous cargo, 2022",
    subtitle = "Provinces are filled by the total tonnage handled at port authorities they host. Grey = no",
    caption = "Source: Directorate General for Maritime Affairs, 2022. Author calculations."
  ) +
  theme_void(base_family = "Inter") +
  theme(
    plot.title = element_text(family = "Playfair Display", face = "italic", size = 22,
                              color = "#3D0823", margin = margin(b = 6)),
    plot.subtitle = element_text(color = "#3D0823", size = 12, margin = margin(b = 10)),
    plot.caption = element_text(color = "#3D0823", size = 10, hjust = 0,
                                margin = margin(t = 8)),
    legend.title = element_text(color = "#3D0823", face = "bold", size = 11),
    legend.text = element_text(color = "#3D0823", size = 10),
    legend.position = "right",
    plot.background = element_rect(fill = "#FFFAF7", color = NA),
    panel.background = element_rect(fill = "#FFFAF7", color = NA)
  )
```

Türkiye's hazardous cargo, 2022

Provinces are filled by the total tonnage handled at port authorities they host. Grey = no port authority in that provi



Source: Directorate General for Maritime Affairs, 2022. Author calculations.

Figure 1: Total hazardous cargo handled in 2022, by host province of the port authority. The darker the province, the heavier the load.

The Aegean coast dominates **İzmir** alone hosts both the **Aliğa** and **İzmir** port authorities, making it the single heaviest concentration on the map. The Eastern Mediterranean follows close behind with **Adana's Ceyhan** terminals and **Hatay's İskenderun** accounting for much of the remainder. The Black Sea, Marmara and Antalya regions are present but noticeably lighter.

3. How is cargo distributed across companies?

Each company's 2022 tonnage is summed and plotted on a log scale to capture the full spread from the smallest handlers to the largest:

```
company_totals <- hns2022 |>
  group_by(company_clean) |>
  summarise(total_mt = sum(cargo_mt), .groups = "drop") |>
  filter(total_mt > 0)

ggplot(company_totals, aes(x = total_mt)) +
  geom_density(fill = "#FF80B0", alpha = 0.55, color = "#C2185B", linewidth = 1) +
  geom_vline(xintercept = 20000, linetype = "dashed", color = "#00C9D8", linewidth = 1) +
  annotate(
    "label",
    x = 20000, y = Inf,
    label = "20,000-ton threshold",
    vjust = 1.5, hjust = -0.05,
    color = "#00838F", fill = "#FFFAF7",
    size = 3.5,
    fontface = "bold"
  ) +
```

```
scale_x_log10(labels = scales::label_number(scale_cut = scales::cut_short_scale())) +
labs(
  title = "Most companies are small. A handful are enormous.",
  subtitle = "Density of company-level total tonnage in 2022 (log-10 axis).",
  x = "Total cargo per company (metric tons, log scale)",
  y = "Density",
  caption = "Each company aggregated by its cleaned, deduplicated name."
) +
theme_riyo()
```

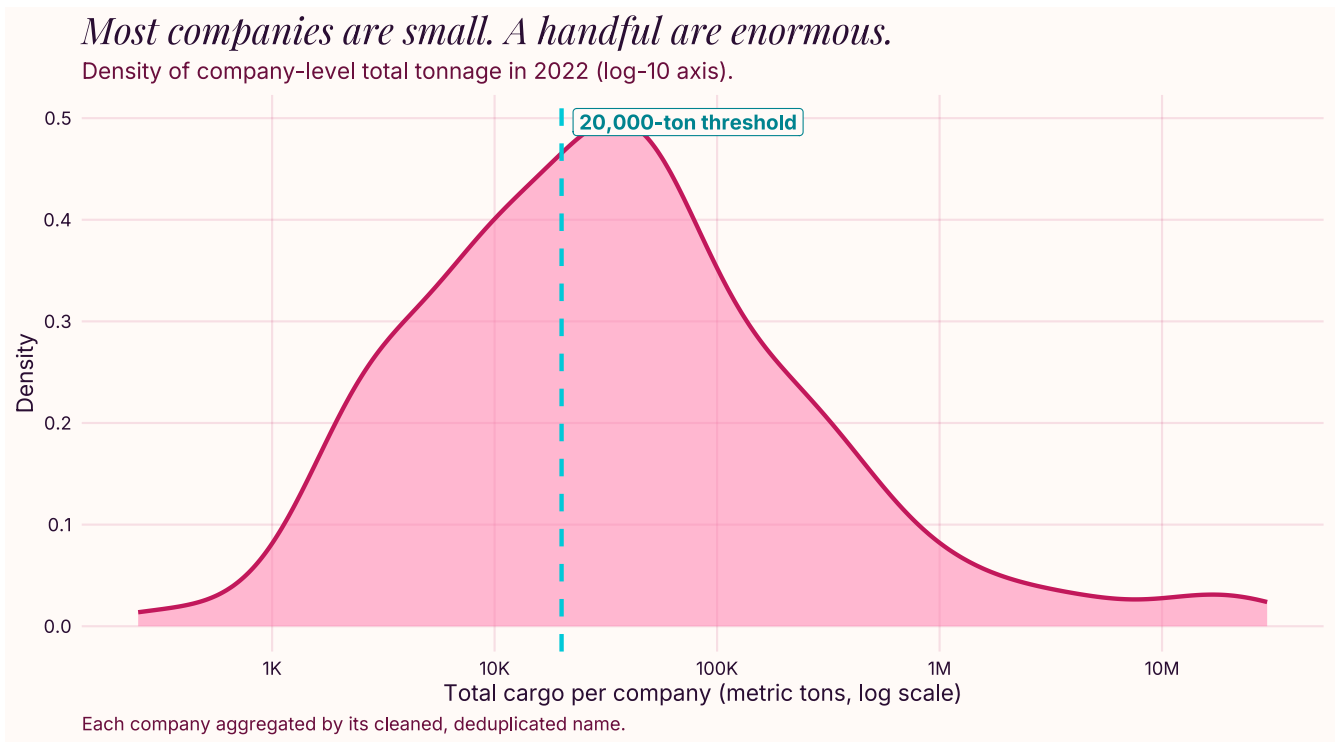


Figure 2: Density of total 2022 hazardous cargo tonnage per company (log scale). The cyan dashed line is the 20,000 ton policy threshold.

The pattern is hard to miss. Most companies cluster in the **10³–10⁴ ton** range, but a thin upper tail stretches well past **10⁷ tons** and that tail is where the real volume lives. On a linear axis, the smaller handlers would barely register; they outnumber the giants but are dwarfed by them in every other sense.

4. Simulated Tax Impact Based on Hazardous Cargo Handling Amounts

The Directorate is weighing tax and regulatory measures for companies that move more than **20,000 tons** of hazardous cargo in a given year. To get a sense of the scale, we run a simple simulation: a hypothetical **50 per ton** levy applied to the full tonnage of any company that crosses that line.

Note. The 50/ton figure is illustrative picked for ease of calculation, not drawn from any draft policy. The totals below are best read as proportions, not forecasts.

```
TAX_RATE_TL_PER_TON <- 50

co_tax <- company_totals |>
  mutate(
    above_threshold = total_mt > 20000,
    tax_TL = if_else(above_threshold, total_mt * TAX_RATE_TL_PER_TON, 0)
```

```

)

threshold_summary <- co_tax |>
  summarise(
    n_total      = n(),
    n_taxed      = sum(above_threshold),
    pct_companies = mean(above_threshold) * 100,
    taxed_mt     = sum(total_mt[above_threshold]),
    total_mt     = sum(total_mt),
    pct_taxed_mt = taxed_mt / total_mt * 100,
    total_tax_TL = sum(tax_TL),
    total_tax_billion = sum(tax_TL) / 1e9
  )

threshold_summary

# A tibble: 1 x 8
  n_total n_taxed pct_companies   taxed_mt   total_mt pct_taxed_mt total_tax_TL
  <int>   <int>     <dbl>       <dbl>     <dbl>       <dbl>       <dbl>
1    180    107       59.4 108330766. 108894605.      99.5  5416538302.
# i 1 more variable: total_tax_billion <dbl>

share_df <- tibble(
  metric = factor(
    c("Companies", "Tonnage moved"),
    levels = c("Companies", "Tonnage moved")
  ),
  above = c(threshold_summary$pct_companies, threshold_summary$pct_taxed_mt),
  below = c(100 - threshold_summary$pct_companies, 100 - threshold_summary$pct_taxed_mt)
) |>
  pivot_longer(c(above, below), names_to = "side", values_to = "pct") |>
  mutate(side = factor(side, levels = c("below", "above"),
    labels = c("Below 20k tons", "Above 20k tons"))) |>
  filter(!is.na(pct))

ggplot(share_df, aes(x = metric, y = pct, fill = side)) +
  geom_col(width = 0.55, na.rm = TRUE) +
  geom_text(
    aes(label = sprintf("%.0f%%", pct)),
    position = position_stack(vjust = 0.5),
    color = "white", fontface = "bold", size = 5,
    family = "Inter",
    na.rm = TRUE
  ) +
  scale_fill_manual(values = c("Below 20k tons" = "#FFC1D8", "Above 20k tons" = "#C2185B")) +
  coord_flip() +
  labs(
    title = "Wide net, top-heavy bill.",
    subtitle = sprintf(
      "%.0f%% of companies cross the 20,000-ton threshold, together they account for ~%.1f%% of all hazardous waste",
      threshold_summary$pct_companies, threshold_summary$pct_taxed_mt
    ),
    x = NULL, y = "Share (%)", fill = NULL,
    caption = "50/ton hypothetical levy applied to crossing companies only."
  ) +
  theme_riyo() +
  theme(legend.position = "top")

```

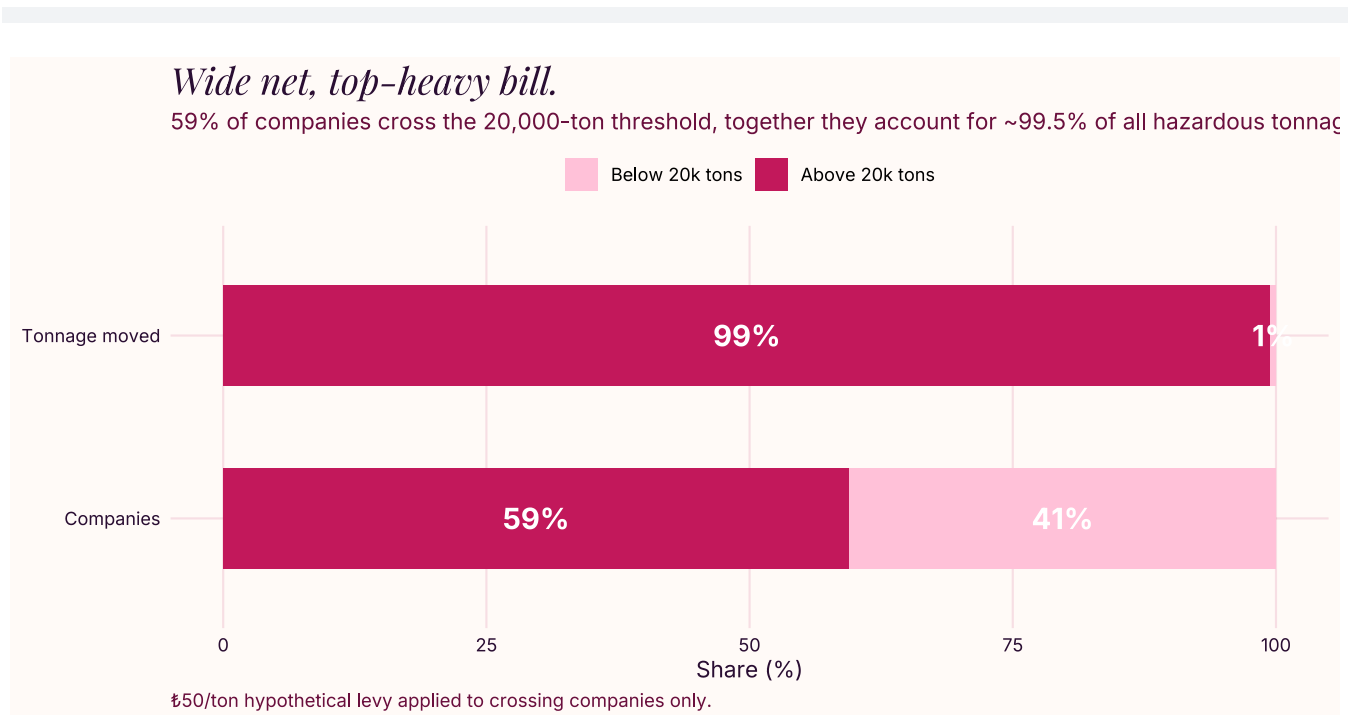


Figure 3: How many companies exceed the threshold and what share of total tonnage they account for.

```
top10_tax <- co_tax |>
  filter(above_threshold) |>
  slice_max(tax_TL, n = 10) |>
  mutate(
    label_short = str_trunc(company_clean, 38),
    label_short = fct_reorder(label_short, tax_TL)
  )

ggplot(top10_tax, aes(x = label_short, y = tax_TL / 1e6)) +
  geom_col(fill = "#C2185B", width = 0.7) +
  geom_text(
    aes(label = scales::label_number(accuracy = 1, big.mark = ",")(tax_TL / 1e6)),
    hjust = -0.15, color = "#2A0E33", family = "Inter", fontface = "bold"
  ) +
  coord_flip() +
  scale_y_continuous(
    labels = scales::label_number(suffix = "M "),
    expand = expansion(mult = c(0, 0.18))
  ) +
  labs(
    title = "Where the bill would land, top 10 hypothetical taxpayers",
    subtitle = sprintf(
      "Total industry liability %.1f billion · top 10 share %.0f%%",
      threshold_summary$total_tax_billion,
      sum(top10_tax$tax_TL) / threshold_summary$total_tax_TL * 100
    ),
    x = NULL, y = "Hypothetical tax (million )",
    caption = "Hypothetical levy: 50 per ton on companies above 20,000 tons of 2022 hazardous cargo."
  ) +
  theme_riyo()
```

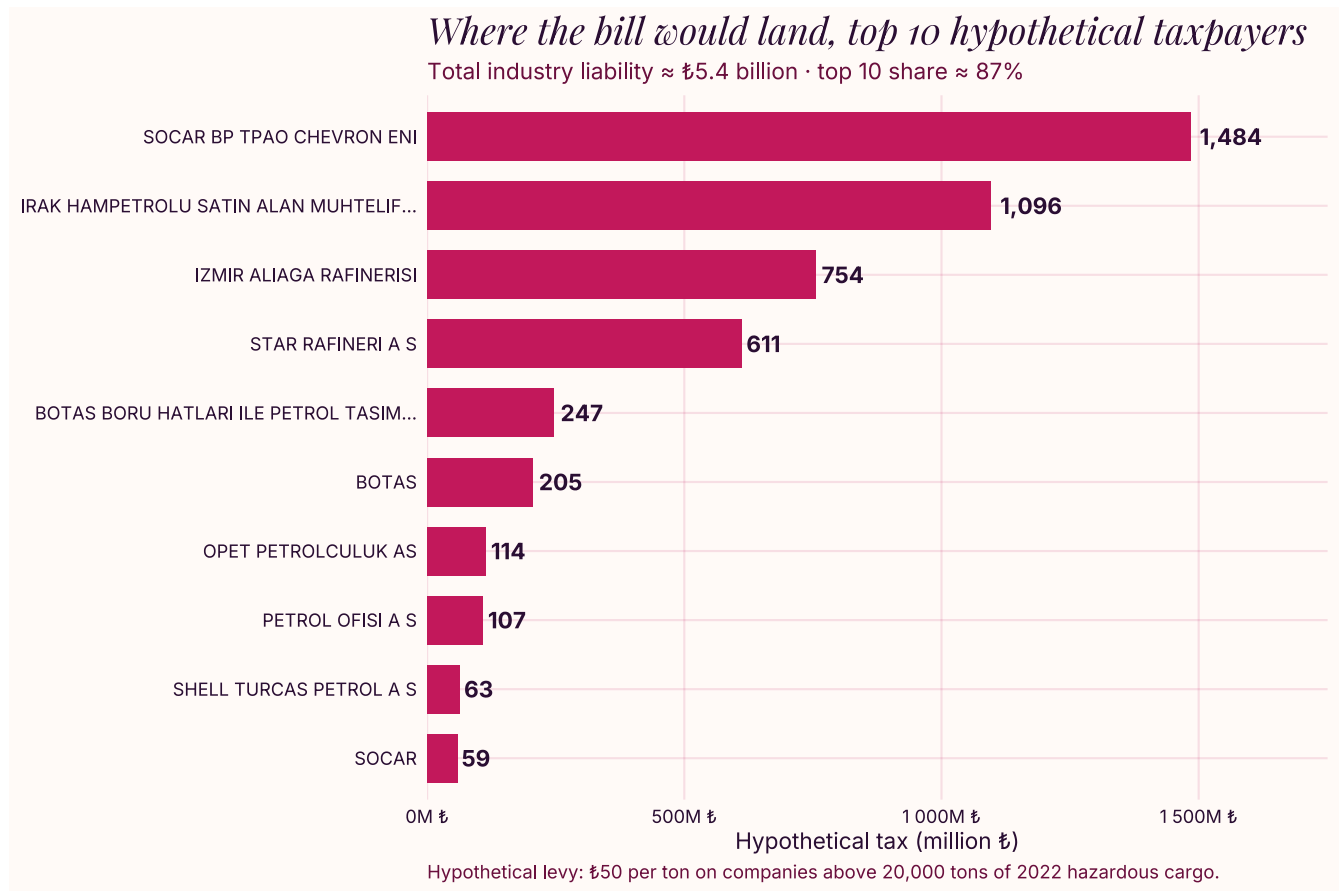


Figure 4: Ten largest hypothetical taxpayers under a 50/ton levy on companies above 20,000 tons.

The top ten alone shoulder the **majority** of the bill. The next several dozen companies above the threshold pay meaningful but much smaller amounts; everyone else pays nothing under this design.

```
top10_tax |>
  transmute(
    Company = label_short,
    `Total tonnage` = scales::label_number(big.mark = ",", accuracy = 1)(total_mt),
    `Hypothetical tax ( million)` = scales::label_number(big.mark = ",", accuracy = 1)(tax_TL / 1e6)
  ) |>
  kable() |>
  kable_styling(bootstrap_options = c("striped", "hover"), full_width = FALSE)
```

Table 1: Top 10 hypothetical taxpayers (50/ton on companies above 20,000 t).

Company	Total tonnage	Hypothetical tax (million)
SOCAR BP TPAO CHEVRON ENI	29,672,726	1,484
IRAK HAMPETROLU SATIN ALAN MUHTELIF...	21,922,189	1,096
IZMIR ALIAGA RAFINERISI	15,088,213	754
STAR RAFINERI A S	12,212,641	611
BOTAS BORU HATLARI ILE PETROL TASIM...	4,937,501	247
BOTAS	4,090,407	205
OPET PETROL CULUK AS	2,276,341	114
PETROL OFISI A S	2,141,034	107
SHELL TURCAS PETROL A S	1,265,607	63

Sensitivity to the threshold

What if the threshold weren't 20,000 tons? The plot below traces how the **number of taxpayers** and the **share of tonnage taxed** move as we slide it.

```
thresholds <- c(5e3, 1e4, 2e4, 5e4, 1e5, 2.5e5, 5e5, 1e6)

sens <- tibble(threshold = thresholds) |>
  rowwise() |>
  mutate(
    n_taxed      = sum(company_totals$total_mt > threshold),
    share_mt     = sum(company_totals$total_mt[company_totals$total_mt > threshold]) /
                  sum(company_totals$total_mt) * 100
  ) |>
  ungroup()

ggplot(sens, aes(x = threshold)) +
  geom_line(aes(y = share_mt), color = "#C2185B", linewidth = 1.2) +
  geom_point(aes(y = share_mt), color = "#C2185B", size = 3) +
  geom_text(
    aes(y = share_mt, label = sprintf("n=%d", n_taxed)),
    vjust = -1, color = "#00838F", fontface = "bold", size = 3.4, family = "Inter"
  ) +
  scale_x_log10(labels = scales::label_number(big.mark = ",", scale_cut = scales::cut_short_scale())) +
  scale_y_continuous(limits = c(0, 105), labels = function(x) paste0(x, "%")) +
  labs(
    title      = "How sharp is the cliff at 20,000 tons?",
    subtitle   = "Even a 5x or 10x stricter threshold barely loses tonnage coverage, the giants dominate.",
    x          = "Threshold (metric tons, log scale)",
    y          = "Share of total tonnage above threshold",
    caption    = "Annotations show the number of companies caught at each threshold."
  ) +
  theme_riyo()
```

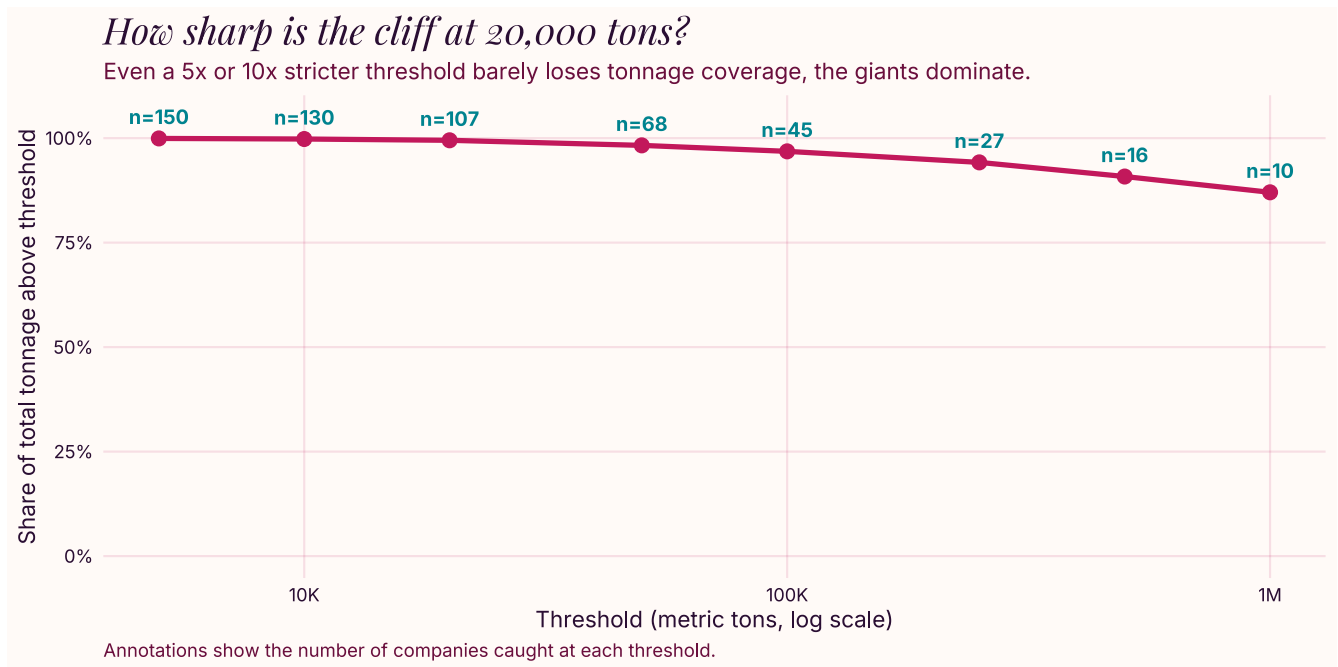



Figure 5: Sensitivity of the policy to the threshold value.

Because the upper tail of the distribution is very large, increasing the threshold significantly reduces the number of companies affected by the policy, while the total amount of covered cargo decreases only slightly. This may help policymakers design a regulation that targets major cargo handlers without affecting too many companies.

5. Where do these companies handle their cargo?

```
port_totals <- hns2022 |>
  group_by(port_authority_short) |>
  summarise(total_mt = sum(cargo_mt), .groups = "drop") |>
  arrange(desc(total_mt))

ggplot(port_totals, aes(x = fct_reorder(port_authority_short, total_mt), y = total_mt / 1e6)) +
  geom_col(fill = "#FF2D87", width = 0.65) +
  coord_flip() +
  scale_y_continuous(labels = scales::label_number(suffix = " M ton")) +
  labs(
    title = "Aliaga and Ceyhan run away with it.",
    subtitle = "Total hazardous cargo handled in 2022, by regional port authority.",
    x = NULL, y = "Total cargo (million metric tons)"
  ) +
  theme_riyo()
```

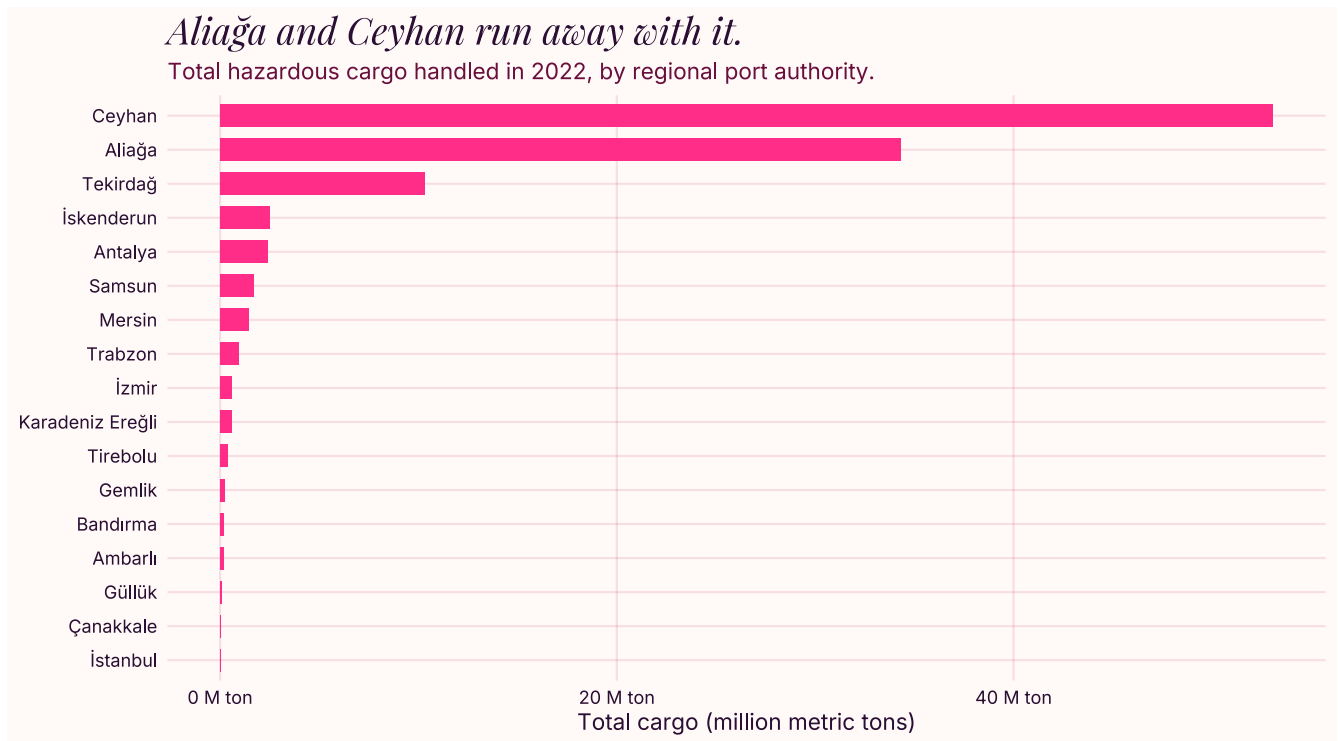


Figure 6: Total hazardous cargo by port authority, 2022.

6. Regional Distribution of Hazardous Cargo Activities

Grouping ports by Türkiye's four coastal regions gives a more balanced view of how typical hazardous cargo movements compare across the country, alongside the giants. The box plot below shows every record in the dataset on a logarithmic axis, keeping both small and very large shipments visible. The box itself covers the middle 50% of cargo movements, the line inside is the median and the dots beyond the whiskers are outliers, often individual megashipments.

```
region_map <- tibble::tribble(
  ~province,    ~region,
  "Balıkesir",  "Marmara",
  "Tekirdağ",   "Marmara",
  "İstanbul",   "Marmara",
  "Çanakkale",  "Marmara",
  "Bursa",      "Marmara",
  "İzmir",      "Aegean",
  "Muğla",      "Aegean",
  "Antalya",    "Mediterranean",
  "Mersin",     "Mediterranean",
  "Adana",      "Mediterranean",
  "Hatay",      "Mediterranean",
  "Samsun",     "Black Sea",
  "Trabzon",    "Black Sea",
  "Giresun",    "Black Sea",
  "Zonguldak",  "Black Sea"
)

hns_region <- hns2022 |>
  left_join(region_map, by = "province") |>
  filter(!is.na(region), !is.na(cargo_mt)) |>
  mutate(region = forcats::fct_reorder(region, cargo_mt, .fun = median, na.rm = TRUE))
```

```

region_palette <- c(
  "Marmara"      = "#C2185B",
  "Aegean"       = "#FF2D87",
  "Mediterranean" = "#E91E63",
  "Black Sea"    = "#880E4F"
)

ggplot(hns_region, aes(x = region, y = cargo_mt, fill = region)) +
  geom_boxplot(alpha = 0.85, color = "#3D0823", outlier.color = "#3D0823",
    outlier.size = 1.8, width = 0.55) +
  scale_y_log10(labels = scales::label_number(scale_cut = scales::cut_short_scale())) +
  scale_fill_manual(values = region_palette, guide = "none") +
  labs(
    title = "Cargo tonnage per record, by coastal region",
    subtitle = "Each point is one company at one facility in 2022. Log-10 axis.",
    x = NULL,
    y = "Cargo per record (metric tons, log scale)",
    caption = "Box: middle 50%. Line: median. Whiskers: 1.5x IQR. Dots: outliers."
  ) +
  theme_riyo()

```

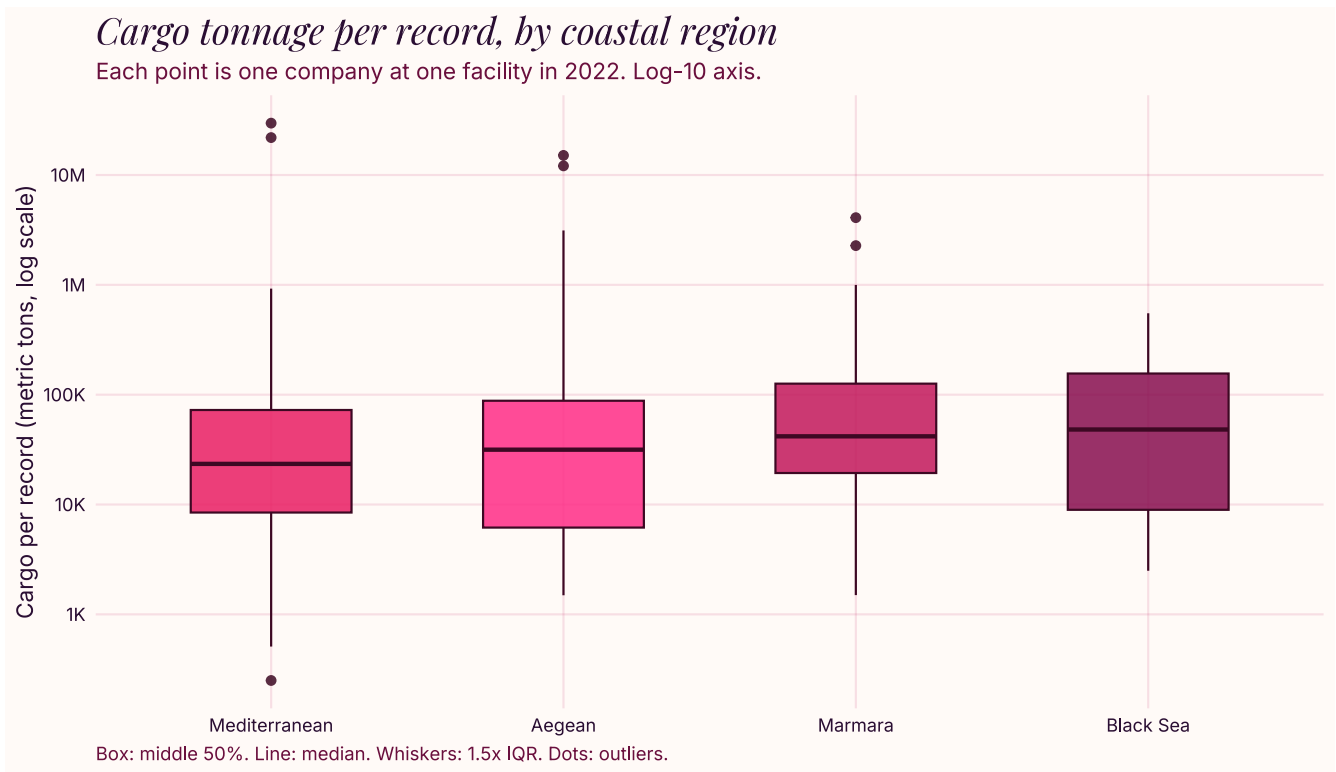


Figure 7: Distribution of leaf-record cargo tonnage across Türkiye's four coastal regions, 2022 (log-10 axis).

The four coastal areas have different hazardous cargo patterns. Marmara and Black Sea coastlines are the two coastal areas with the highest average cargo volumes, with median cargo volumes of about 50,000 tons. This can be attributed to the continuous operations of petroleum terminals and liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) terminals found in locations like İstanbul, Tekirdağ, Samsun, and Karadeniz Ereğli.

Mediterranean is the area with the lowest median cargo volume; however, it also holds some of the largest cargo volumes in the dataset. Operations at ports such as Ceyhan and İskenderun result in extraordinarily large cargo volumes when compared to the other regions.

The Aegean area is in between the above scenarios where there are medium-sized cargo volumes, though some facilities like the Aliğa refinery and Star Aliğa terminal hold some of the highest cargo volume records in the dataset.

7. Conclusions

- **Geography:** Türkiye’s hazardous cargo handling is **not evenly distributed**. A small set of provinces driven by refining and large export terminals, dominates national volume.
- **Industry structure:** The market is a **classic heavy tailed distribution**. Many small handlers, a few giants moving most of the tonnage.
- **Policy implication:** Because volume is so concentrated, a tonnagebased levy is **administratively narrow**. It would touch a minority of companies but capture most of the activity. That makes it both **easy to enforce** and **politically charged**.
- **Sensitivity:** Moving the threshold from 20,000 to 100,000 or 200,000 tons would *not* meaningfully reduce coverage of total tonnage but would *significantly* reduce the number of regulated firms a real lever for policy designers.

Visit our [Data page](#) for documentation and the cleaned dataset and the [Team page](#) to meet the people behind it.